Level 1 Literacy: Curves, Letters and Rhymes

Three one-hour sessions that prepare the hand and the ear for reading and writing Bengali

1. How each session runs

Time	Part	What happens
0–30 min	**Circle: letters and rhymes**	Five to eight children sit in a circle around the volunteer. The volunteer reads each letter and its rhyme aloud, pointing at the letter and then at its picture on the chart. Children repeat.
30–60 min	**Tracing**	Children trace strokes, patterns and pictures on the printed sheets. Colouring is homework.

KEY IDEA
Two things matter most in the circle: how the letter sounds, and which picture goes with it. Do not worry yet about children writing letters perfectly.



Figure 1. The alphabet chart used in the circle. Each letter has a picture and a rhyme.

2. Plan for the three weeks

Week	Circle (30 min)	Tracing (30 min)
1	First half of the alphabet chart: letters, pictures and rhymes.	Sheets A and B: straight lines, then curves.
2	Second half of the chart. Start with a quick review of week 1.	Sheets C and D: shapes, sun and flowers.
3	Vowels: say each vowel, show the picture, and let children who are comfortable with the rhymes colour the letter that matches each picture.	Sheets E and F: the boat, then vowel practice.

3. Teaching guide

The circle

1. Point to a letter. Say it slowly **twice**. Children say it back.
2. Point to the picture. Ask: "What is this?" Let a child answer.
3. Read the rhyme with a clear beat. Clap on each beat. Children join in.
4. Ask one child to point and the others to say. Let every child take a turn as the "teacher".

Tracing well

- Sit with **feet flat**, back straight, paper held still with the other hand.
- Hold the pencil with thumb and two fingers, not in a fist. Show it; do not just tell.
- Start at the dot, and say "slow, slow" as the pencil moves. Praise **staying on the line**, not speed.
- Left-handed children: let them move the paper to the left, and sit them where they do not bump a neighbour.

TIP
A child who finds tracing hard can first draw the stroke in the air, then with a finger in a tray of sand or rice, then with a pencil.

4. The eleven vowels (স্বরবর্ণ) for week 3

Say the vowel, then the word. The picture on the chart (or one you draw on the board) helps children remember.

Vowel	Example word	Sounds like	Meaning
অ	অজগর	ajagar	python
আ	আম	aam	mango

Vowel	Example word	Sounds like	Meaning
ই	ইঁদুর	indur	mouse
ঈ	ঈগল	eegol	eagle
উ	উট	ut	camel
ঊ	ঊষা	usha	dawn
ঋ	ঋষি	rishi	sage
এ	একতারা	ektara	one-string lute
ঐ	ঐরাবত	oirabot	royal elephant
ও	ওল	ol	yam
ঔ	ঔষধ	oushodh	medicine

NOTE
The sound of অ is short and round, "aw" as in "law". Many children say "o"; gently repeat the correct sound. ঋ is rare in everyday words, so introduce it last and do not over-drill it.

5. Extra activities if time remains

- **Letter hunt:** each child finds a letter on the classroom wall chart and shows it to a friend.
- **Sound clap:** say a word, children clap once for every part (আ-ম = 2 claps).
- **Body letters:** make a curve with arms, a line with the body, a circle with both hands.
- **My name:** write the child's first letter large, and let them trace it with a finger.

TIP
See document 15 for more games, and document 16 to record each child's progress.

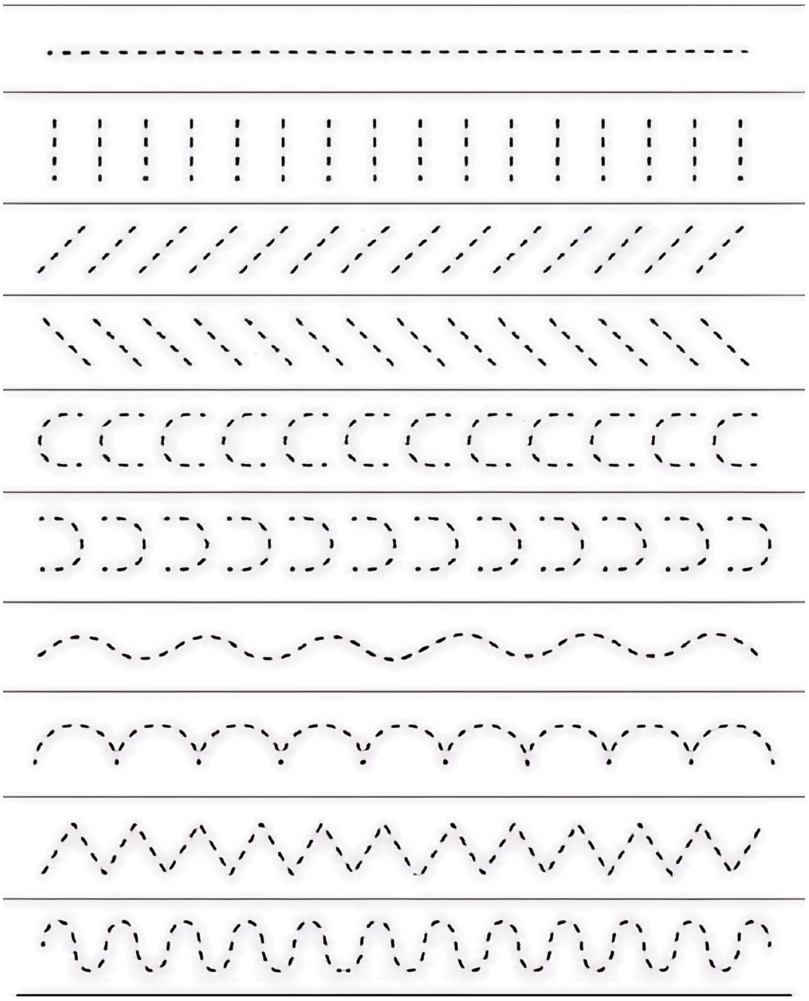
Student worksheets

Print one set per child. Colour the pictures at home.

Name: _____	Date: _____

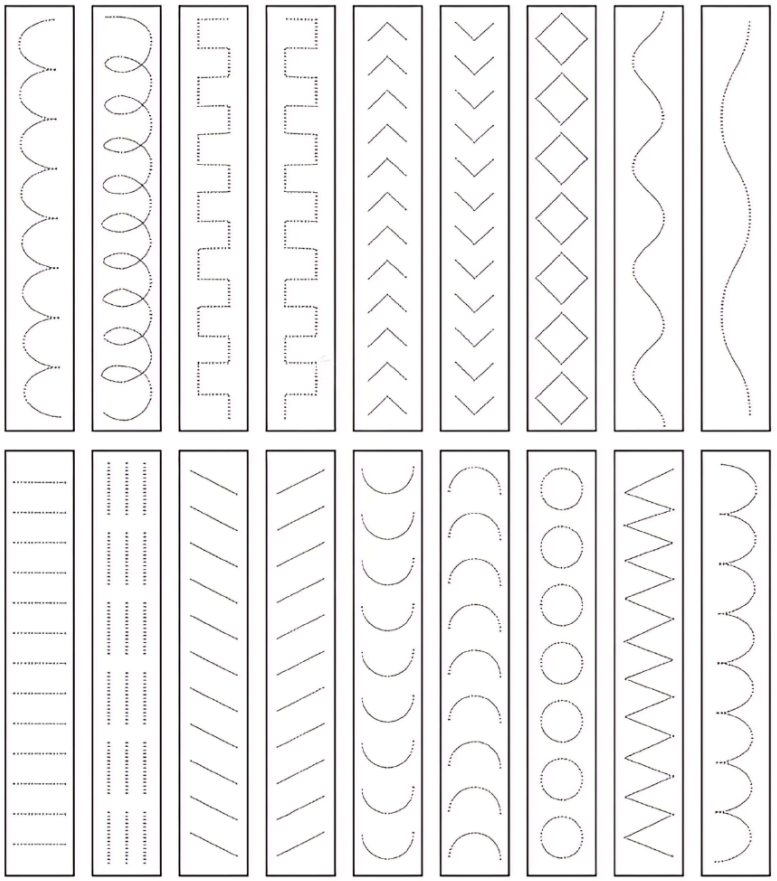
Sheet A (week 1): straight lines

পেনসিল দিয়ে বিন্দু থেকে বিন্দু পর্যন্ত দাগের উপর দিয়ে চালাও।
Go over the lines with a pencil, from the dot to the end.



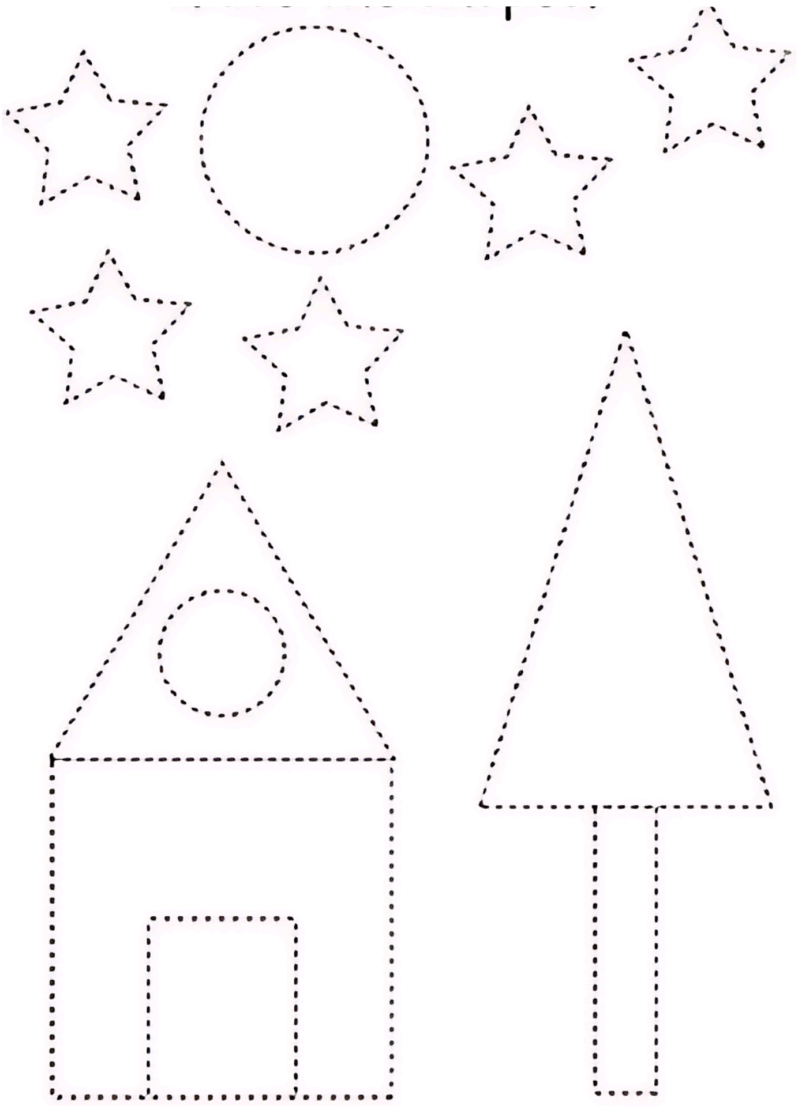
Sheet B (week 1): curves

ধীরে ধীরে বাঁকা দাগের উপর পেনসিল চালাও।
Trace the curves slowly.



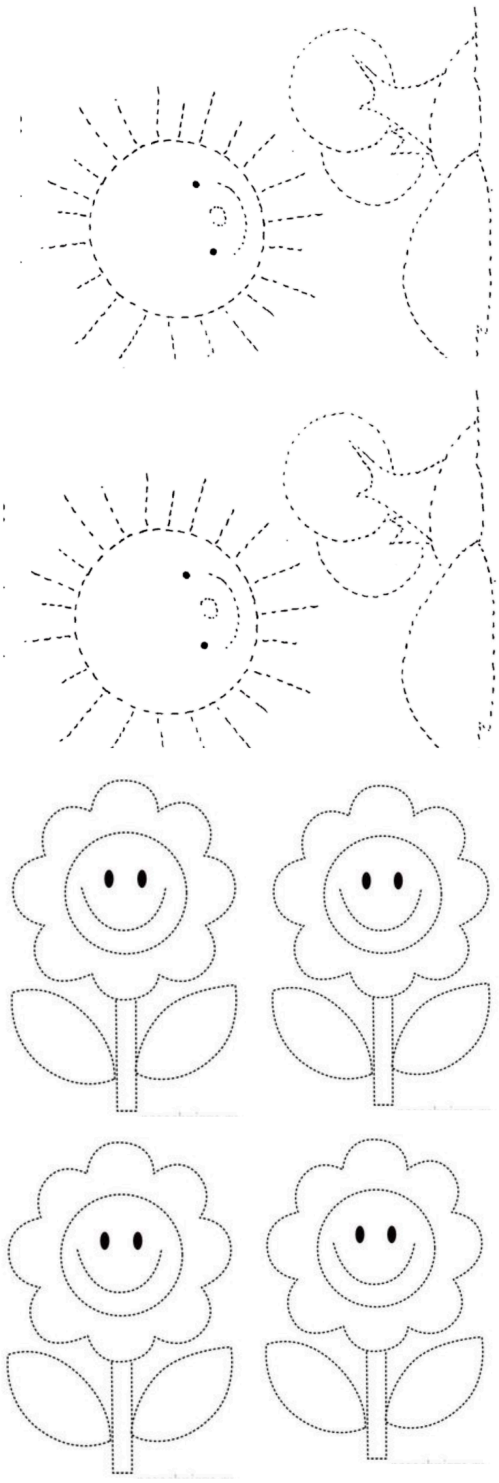
Sheet C (week 2): shapes

আকারগুলোর উপর পেনসিল চালাও, তারপর রং করো।
Trace each shape, then colour it.



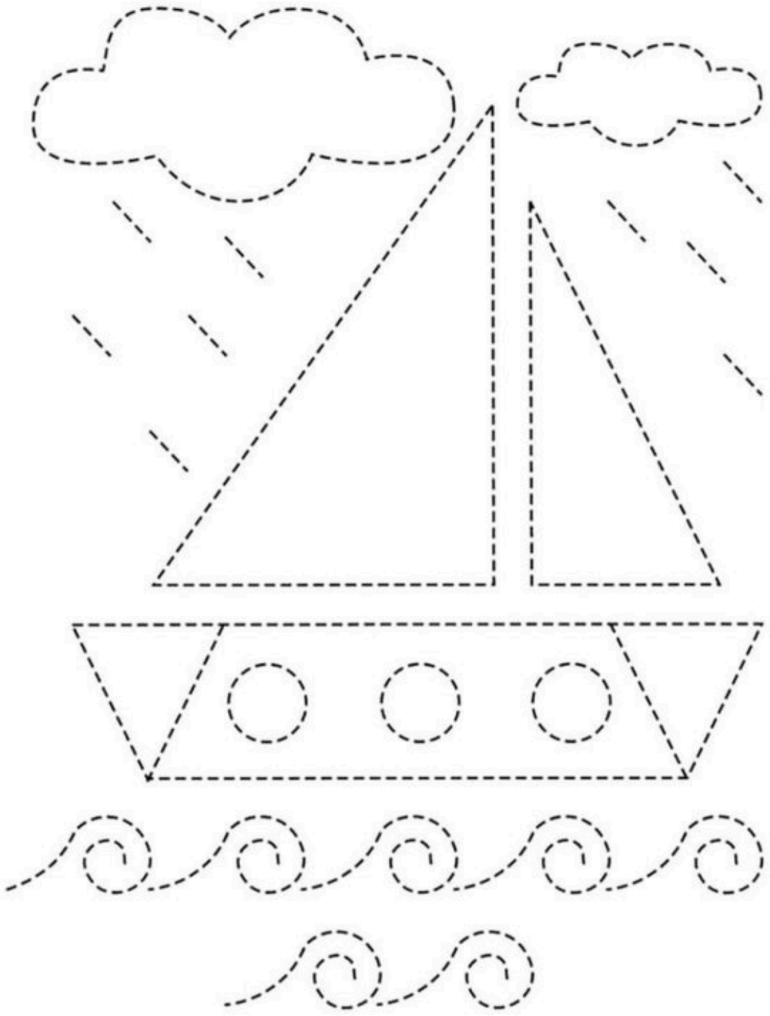
Sheet D (week 2): sun and flowers

সূর্য আর ফুলের দাগের উপর পেনসিল চালাও।
Trace the sun and the flowers.



Sheet E (week 3): the boat

নৌকার ছবিটা ট্রেস করো, তারপর রং করো।
Trace the boat, then colour it.



Sheet F (week 3): vowels

ছবির সঙ্গে মিলিয়ে স্বরবর্ণগুলো দেখে নাও, তারপর হালকা অক্ষরের উপর পেনসিল চালাও।
Look at the vowels with their pictures, then trace the pale letters.

	ই	আ	ঈ	অ
	উ	৯	ঋ	ই
	এ	ঊ	ঐ	ই
	ও	আ	ঐ	ঈ
	ঔ	আ	ঈ	ঋ
	ও	আ	ঐ	ঈ
	ও	আ	ঐ	ঈ
	এ	ঊ	ঐ	ই
	উ	৯	ঋ	ই
	উ	৯	ঋ	ই
	এ	ঊ	ঐ	ই
	ঔ	আ	ঈ	ঋ

Vowel tracing

অ আ ই ঈ উ ঊ

ঋ এ ঐ ও ঔ

অ অ অ অ অ অ

আ আ আ আ আ আ

ই ই ই ই ই ই

আমার পছন্দের স্বরবর্ণ আর তার শব্দ লিখি:

My favourite vowel and a word that starts with it:
